# Synvitta Diagnostics

**U.S. Market Entry Challenge | UF Rise to Leadership MBA**

## Company Background

Synvitta Diagnostics is an early-stage biotechnology company based at UF Innovate | Sid Martin Biotech in Alachua, Florida. We develop laboratory test kits, compact testing instruments, and software. Our first commercial efforts have focused on Brazil; we now need to decide how to build our business in the United States.

## Three Opportunities Under Consideration

| | |
|---|---|
| **SynELISA™ \| Research kits** | Three individual testing kits for Research Use Only (RUO): TSH and T4 (thyroid-related markers) and antibodies related to syphilis. Potential near-term sales to suitable research customers; not for patient diagnosis. |
| **SynArray™ \| Newborn screening** | A multiplex platform in late-stage development intended to measure multiple newborn screening markers from one sample. Potential future clinical market, but additional development, validation and an appropriate regulatory pathway are required. |
| **SynArray™ \| Custom panels** | The platform may also support tailored multi-marker tests for partners, such as SynHormone™, a hormone-focused panel concept. Potential business models include research collaborations and paid co-development projects. |

## The Real Business Challenge

Synvitta has limited resources and does not currently have FDA authorization to market these products for clinical diagnostic use in the United States. Its challenge is to identify realistic near-term revenue and partnership opportunities while building toward future clinical commercialization.

**How should Synvitta enter the U.S. market with its current and developing products, without treating FDA authorization as something it already has?**

## Important Regulatory Context — Plain English

- RUO (Research Use Only): Products intended and marketed solely for genuine research activities, not for clinical diagnosis or treatment decisions.
- CLIA: U.S. quality requirements for laboratories that test human specimens for clinical purposes. A CLIA-certified laboratory is not automatically authorized to market or use any research kit for patient diagnosis.
- FDA: Oversees diagnostic devices and their intended uses. Clinical pathways, including qualifying laboratory-developed testing arrangements, require case-specific regulatory review. Students should identify questions to verify, not deliver legal opinions.

## Your Role: MBA Consulting Team

Recommend ONE priority opportunity for Synvitta to pursue first in the U.S. Consider the three product opportunities above, but do not create three full business plans. Assume approximately four hours for research, discussion and presentation preparation.

## Three Guiding Questions

**1. Where should Synvitta focus first?** Choose SynELISA research kits, SynArray newborn-screening partnerships, or SynArray custom panel development. Compare business potential, readiness, barriers and speed to first revenue.

**2. What is a credible route to market?** Identify an appropriate customer or partner type and a possible business model (RUO research sales, research evaluation or collaboration, custom development, or a laboratory partnership for expert regulatory assessment). Explain why it is appropriate and what cannot be assumed without FDA authorization.

**3. What should we do in the next 90 days?** Propose three achievable actions, identify 2–3 prospective U.S. customers or partners, and choose two simple metrics to track progress.

## Team Deliverable

Prepare a 3–5 slide presentation with: (1) recommended product opportunity and customer; (2) proposed commercial or partnership approach and the key regulatory assumption to verify; (3) a practical 90-day plan with 2–3 potential partners and TWO measures of progress. Highlight one major risk. No FDA filing strategy, detailed financial forecast or nationwide market-sizing exercise is required.

## Questions to Explore (Not Assumptions)

- Where can Synvitta legitimately offer RUO products today, and how could it reach research buyers?
- Could collaborations with CLIA-certified laboratories or diagnostic developers help validate demand and develop future pathways? What regulatory and business facts must be checked first?
- Would customized multiplex development provide a faster or more attractive initial business opportunity than selling standard kits?

## Quick Glossary

Assay = laboratory test | Multiplex = testing several markers from one sample | RUO = research only, not patient diagnosis | CLIA = clinical laboratory standards | FDA = U.S. Food and Drug Administration | Pilot = small evaluation | Co-development = partners jointly developing a product

*Regulatory reading (optional): FDA RUO guidance; FDA Laboratory Developed Tests overview; CMS Getting Started with CLIA.*